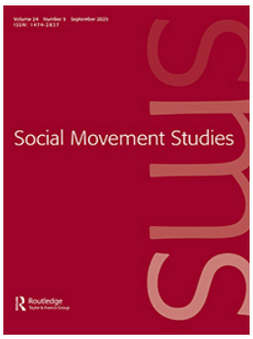

Social Movement Studies

ISSN: 1474-2837 (Print) 1474-2829 (Online) Journal homepage: www.tandfonline.com/journals/csms20

Ocean activism: understanding political acts in extra-national terrain

Antje Scharenberg

To cite this article: Antje Scharenberg (2025) Ocean activism: understanding political acts in extra-national terrain, Social Movement Studies, 24:5, 588-603, DOI: 10.1080/14742837.2024.2321142

To link to this article: https://doi.org/10.1080/14742837.2024.2321142

© 2024 The Author(s). Published by Informa UK Limited, trading as Taylor & Francis Group.

Published online: 27 Feb 2024.

Submit your article to this journal

Article views: 1957

View related articles

View Crossmark data

Citing articles: 4 View citing articles

Full Terms & Conditions of access and use can be found at
https://www.tandfonline.com/action/journalInformation?journalCode=csms20

SOCIAL MOVEMENT STUDIES
2025, VOL. 24, NO. 5, 588–603
https://doi.org/10.1080/14742837.2024.2321142

Routledge
Taylor & Francis Group

OPEN ACCESS Check for updates

Ocean activism: understanding political acts in extra-national terrain

Antje Scharenberg

Department of Media and Culture, Institute for Media and Communications Management, University of St Gallen, St Gallen, Switzerland

ABSTRACT

From enslaved people capturing vessels during the Middle Passage to Greenpeace's and Sea Shepherd's famous anti-whaling campaigns in the latter half of the twentieth century – resistance at sea is a phenomenon that is as old as human seafaring. Yet, while social movement scholars have a long-standing interest in transnational movements and what it means to act politically *beyond* the borders of nation-states, much less is known about social movements acting *outside* of national territory, in the international waters of the planetary ocean. This article addresses this gap by bringing the phenomenon of sea-oriented civil society to the attention of social movement scholars and proposing a conceptual framework for understanding *ocean activism*. Bringing together currently scattered accounts of maritime movements with relevant literature from the recent ocean turn across the social and political sciences, the article argues that we may understand ocean activism along three defining, sea-specific characteristics: (1) *material specificity* (due to the sea's elemental qualities), (2) *technological dependency* (from ships to AIS), and (3) *extra-territoriality* (outside national jurisdiction). The paper contributes to discussions of transnational social movements in particular, demonstrating that scholarly attention to the ocean enables new perspectives on their spatial politics, media and data practices, and materiality. Thus, addressing social movement scholarship's terrestrial bias does not only allow us to begin to conceptualize ocean activism but opens up paths to better understand political acts in extra-national terrains, in and beyond the sea.

ARTICLE HISTORY
Received 1 March 2023
Accepted 11 January 2024

KEYWORDS
Ocean activism; transnational social movements; spatial politics; maritime civil society; data activism

Introduction

Since the early days of human seafaring, the ocean has not only been a site of geopolitics and trade, but also of resistance and struggle. Historically, as Linebaugh and Rediker's (Linebaugh & Rediker, 2013) work on the revolutionary Atlantic demonstrates, the ocean has always been populated by motley crews of pirates, runaways and sailors. Until today, resistance at sea takes place across different oceans and struggles. Pacific islanders, for instance, famously resisted colonial nations' nuclear testing in the 1970s (Swan, 2022).

CONTACT Antje Scharenberg antje.scharenberg@unisg.ch Department of Media and Culture, Institute for Media and Communications Management, University of St Gallen, Blumenbergplatz 9, St Gallen 9000, Switzerland

© 2024 The Author(s). Published by Informa UK Limited, trading as Taylor & Francis Group.
This is an Open Access article distributed under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License (http://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/), which permits unrestricted use, distribution, and reproduction in any medium, provided the original work is properly cited. The terms on which this article has been published allow the posting of the Accepted Manuscript in a repository by the author(s) or with their consent.

Throughout and beyond the twentieth century, dockers and maritime workers have organized in international alliances around the world (Featherstone, 2022). On a Dutch-flagged ship, the organization Women on Waves provided offshore abortions for women from countries where these are illegal (Arella, 2017), while Greenpeace and Sea Shepherd have resisted commercial whaling since the 1970s (Scarce, 2006). These are but a few instances of a rich history of sea-oriented struggle. Yet, ocean activism is a phenomenon that remains curiously under-investigated from a social movement studies perspective.

This comparative lack of scholarly attention is particularly puzzling given that social movement scholars have, for many years, been interested in the transnational dimension of social movements and the question what it means to act in international terrain. However, while scholars considered how social movements enact agency *beyond* the borders of nation-states, as I will show in the next section, they have turned somewhat of a blind eye to activism taking place *outside of the territory of nation-states*, in the international waters of the planetary ocean. The aim of this article is to begin to address this land-based bias in social movements scholarship by offering a conceptualization of ocean activism and what it means for civil society to *act politically at sea*.

In this article, I propose to define ocean activism as *sea-oriented acts of resistance*. The words 'sea-oriented' and 'acts of resistance' have been intentionally chosen to indicate a deliberately wide range of (1) *sea-oriented* spaces and (2) actors of *resistance*. Firstly, the term *sea-oriented* refers to both physical and discursive engagement with the sea. In other words, while this article primarily discusses ship- and sea-based campaigns as particularly illustrative case studies, ocean activism does not exclusively take place *at sea*. I agree, here, with geographers who demonstrated how the ocean is spatially distributed (Griffin, 2022) and 'more-than-wet' (Peters & Steinberg, 2019), meaning that it should be understood as a space that expands beyond fluid territory and across different geographies. This thus includes sea-oriented activism that operates in the sky through drones (Fish, 2022), mobile phones (Noori, 2022) or satellite data (Drakopulos et al., 2022) as well as on land, as in the case of dockworker mobilizations (Featherstone, 2022). As I will demonstrate later in this article, there are, or course, crucial differences between land- and sea-based action, not least in terms of their complex relations with land-based regimes. Nevertheless, I deliberately abstain from setting up a disproven binary opposition between the land and the sea (see Lehman et al., 2021). Instead, the term *sea-oriented* signals how regardless of whether respective acts take place in the air, on land or at sea, an orientation towards the ocean impacts on actors' ability to resist in numerous ways, as this article will demonstrate.

Secondly, the term *acts of resistance* deliberately broadens my definition of ocean activism to include a diverse range of non-state, bottom-up actors. This definition firstly serves to distinguish political acts *from below* from nation- or institutions- driven *maritime geopolitics*. In other words, I propose that we understand '*thalassopolitics* – the politics of the sea –' (Kosmatopoulos, 2023, p. 7, original emphasis) not only with regards to how nation-states exercise or compete for power at sea (e.g. Squire, 2021). Rather, I focus on what Kosmatopoulos terms '"popular thalassopolitics"', which 'allows us to conceptually transcend state-centric as well as terra-centric perspectives that tend to impose the analytical lens of security and sovereignty on the maritime terrain' (2023, p. 4). Further, I deliberately speak of *acts of resistance* rather than *social movements*, to include different organizational *forms* (from grassroots activists and social movements to

trade unions and NGOs) and thematic *struggles* (from feminist and anti-colonial to environmental and worker-led acts of resistance). I agree, here, with Kosmatopoulos (2023), who links maritime Palestinian activism to contemporary sea rescue in the Mediterranean as well as to environmental and workers resistance at sea to stress *the necessity to historicize and theorize sea-oriented acts of resistance* beyond individual instances, struggles or organizational forms.

This approach may be less conventional in social movement scholarship, which usually distinguishes between different organizational *forms* such as NGOs and SMOs (e.g. Lang, 2012) and seeks to 'contrast social movements to other collective action processes', not least due to key differences in repertoires, resources and organizational structures (della Porta & Diani, 2006, p. 22). However, for the purpose of conceptualizing ocean activism, I believe that it is useful to follow Hughes, who argues that an 'a priori delineation of resistant forms' (Hughes, 2020, p. 1142) risks overlooking important aspects of how resistance may be understood. Using the wider concept of '"resistant" activities", under which she loosely groups 'counter-conduct, social movements, activism, [or] subversive tactics' (p. 1142), can help diagnose gaps in the field and open up new paths of conceptual understanding.

As I will demonstrate, while we are confronted with a phenomenon that is extremely diverse, what sea-oriented acts of resistance ultimately share is the need to grapple with sea-specific aspects. In order to draw out and conceptualize these sea-specific aspects of ocean activism, this article reviews relevant literature based on research conducted in the context of a wider study which investigates social movements' political agency at sea (Scharenberg, 2022). Firstly, bringing together literature on the spatial politics of transnational social movements with scholarship from a recent ocean turn, I demonstrate how social movement scholarship holds an inherent terrestrial bias and why it is important to address this conceptually. Secondly, I pull together the currently scattered research on maritime movements and argue that we may understand ocean activism along three defining qualities, as (1) *materially specific* (due to the sea's elemental qualities), (2) *technologically dependent* (from ships to AIS), and (3) *extra-territorial* (outside national jurisdiction).

Demonstrating how an analysis of each of these qualities advances our understanding of the *spatial politics* of transnational social movements, I show how scholarly attention to maritime civil society does not only deepen our understanding of ocean activism. It also opens up new approaches to understanding political acts in *extra-national terrains* in and beyond the ocean, including in the atmosphere and outer space.

The terrestrial bias of social movement scholarship

From the internationalism of early workers' struggles to the transnational spread of suffragettes, social movement mobilizations have long held a transnational dimension. Yet, in the context of advancing globalization and with the advent of digital technologies in the late 20th century, the question how social movements organize across the borders of nation-states has become an important strand in social movement scholarship. Transnational social movement scholars have shed light on two mobilizations in particular: firstly, throughout the early 2000s, the alter-globalization movements and the Zapatistas in Mexico, whose call for resistance against neoliberal globalization was

echoed in World Social Forums and others global actions (e.g. della Porta & Tarrow, 2005; Flesher Fominaya, 2014); and, secondly, the movements of the squares – including the Occupy Movement, the so-called 'Arab Spring' and the Greek and Spanish Indignados, who took to the squares across and beyond Europe throughout the 2010s (e.g. Castells, 2012; Flesher Fominaya, 2014). Much of this scholarship focussed on how information technologies and digital media mattered for these movements. One predominant conceptual paradigm here was the idea of the *network* (Scharenberg, 2021b), referring both to the *networking logic* (Juris, 2008) inherent to social movements' way of organizing and their use of digital *social networks* as organizational tools (e.g. Castells, 2012).

Importantly, scholars demonstrated that the network paradigm speaks not only to movements' use of media technologies, but also to their *spatial politics*. Scholarship on the geographies of transnational movements specifically highlighted the *multi-scalar* politics of early 21st century political actors. Discussing the multi-scalar spatiality of People's Global Action (PGA), Routledge explains how '[s]pace is bound into local to global networks' (Routledge, 2003, p. 336). He demonstrates this by showing how place-based struggles are weaved together by digital networking technologies, while collective identity is sustained and 'based upon gatherings in particular places' (Routledge, 2003, p. 341). Additionally, mobile actions like activist caravans (see also Scharenberg, 2021b) contribute to strengthening trans-local connections towards 'a multi-scalar politics of solidarity' (Routledge, 2003, p. 341). In as similar vein, other movement scholars have conceptualized transnational mobilizations with kindred spatial politics as *nomadic*, *trans-municipal* (Scharenberg, 2021b) and *trans-local* (McFarlane, 2009), in part to offer alternatives to the predominant *network* paradigm.

What is striking here and unites much of the work on the spatial politics of transnational social movements, is that respective work, including my own (Scharenberg, 2021b), often highlights the importance of *local places* as an alternative to nation-centred politics. Indeed, while 'the globalization of protest involves the interpenetration and multiplicity of forces at local, regional, national and global scales' respective movements often 'remain local or national based' (Routledge, 2003, pp. 335–336). Thus, transnational networks like the PGA stay somewhat *rooted* in certain places, even where these are scaled up, networked or global in their outlook. Alternatively, another way in which social movement scholars have explained transnational mobilizations is through the lens of *regional* identities, such as Europe or the European Union (Scharenberg, 2021a, 2021b; della Porta & Caiani, 2009; Flesher Fominaya & Cox, 2013). Here, researchers showed that while movements harshly critique Europe's colonial violence or the EU's neoliberal policies, they are nevertheless forced to engage with and negotiate 'Europe' as a cultural concept, political institution or geographic space – even if as *alter*- rather than *pro*-Europeans (Scharenberg, 2021a, 2021b).

What this overview of literature on the spatial politics of transnational social movements demonstrates, then, is that respective discussions have reached a conceptual impasse by which mobilizations are primarily analysed on a binary spectrum between local and global. Along this scale, respective scholarship conceptualized transnational mobilizations as alternatives to nation-centred narrations based on their spatial focus *below* (*sub*-national, local mobilizations), *across* (*inter*-national or *trans*-local mobilizations) or *beyond* (*supra*-national or regional mobilizations) the

territories of nation-states. However, a significant blind spot that runs across all these approaches is an *inherent terra-centrism* (see also Davies, 2013, 2019, 2020; Kosmatopoulos, 2019, 2023), which ignores how movements organize in territories *outside* or *on the edges* of national territories – including in the *extra-national territory* of the planetary ocean.

More than addressing an empirical gap or merely adding another context in which transnational mobilization takes place, a focus on ocean activism can thus mitigate a conceptual shortcoming in our theoretical understanding of the spatial politics of transnational social movements. The sea presents an ideal space from which to rethink the spatial politics of transnational social movements, not least because approximately half of the planet's surface lies outside of national jurisdiction and the deep seabed being defined by the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS) as the *common heritage of humankind* (Armstrong & Scharenberg, 2023). Thus, more than 'primarily defensive in character', as Routledge (2003, p. 347) described the grassroots globalization networks around the turn of the century, movements active in extra-national terrain may have the potential to point to alternative visions of organizing politically in ways that do not start with a predominant nation-based way of structuring politics.

In order to begin to conceptualize ocean activism, it is useful, then, to draw on literature that shows how social movement scholars are not alone in their terra-centric bias. As part of a wider '"oceanic turn" [...] across the humanities and social sciences' (Brown & Peters, 2019, p. 1), scholars have demonstrated how the modern world – and the social and political sciences – is permeated by a certain 'sea-sickness' (Colás, 2022, p. 26), 'landward (or terrestrial) bias' or 'terracentric normative ideal' (Peters et al., 2018, p. 2). This bias derives not only from the fact that the land 'is where most of us reside', but also from its 'assumed stability', which allows for land to be controlled and partitioned though bordering technologies such as walls, fences or checkpoints (p. 2). Thus, respective scholarship shows how intimately the land-based order is tied to the 'Westphalian concept of nation-state sovereignty' (Hung & Lien, 2022, p. 3), which also permeates much of the epistemic foundations of our contemporary political concepts. More than merely correcting modern thought's land-based bias, then, the ocean 'can reinvigorate, redirect, and reshape debates that are all too often restricted by terrestrial limits' (Steinberg & Peters, 2015, p. 247), and offer a 'rich array of possibilities for developing, modifying, and applying theoretical perspectives' (Steinberg, 1999, p. 367).

Indeed, some scholars have already begun to criticize the 'ocean-shaped hole' (Armstrong in Armstrong & Scharenberg, 2023, p. 10) in studies of global justice. As Federici argues, while the global fishermen's movement, which spread across the world from India in the late 1990s, was of significant importance to the struggle against neoliberal globalization and should be understood 'as a new international political subject', it was 'generally ignored by most "global justice" theoreticians and activists' (Federici, 2014, pp. 13–14). Similarly, Kosmatopoulos, who studied the initiative Ships to Gaza, sees 'sea-based solidarity' as a new form of solidarity politics, which has gone 'largely understudied' (Kosmatopoulos, 2019, p. 1). Moreover, Davies (2019) shows how a terrestrial bias even pertains in analyses of maritime resistance, such as the Royal Indian Navy mutiny of 1946, which, he argues, largely discount the mutiny's maritime dimension. This is particularly striking given that 'terraqueous solidarities' invite us to re-think

'the boundaries of the political beyond the terrestrial' (Kosmatopoulos, 2019, pp. 3–4) and understand the transnational dimension of resistance from a new angle.

Very recently, a growing number of scholars have thus begun to pay closer attention to the specific qualities of sea-oriented acts of resistance. This is not least since Europe's so-called 'refugee crisis' has fuelled scholarly interest in migrant solidarity action in the Mediterranean Sea. Much of this scholarship has focussed on the criminalization of solidarity or the competing logics of humanitarianism, border securitization and politicization of sea rescue (della Porta & Steinhilper, 2022, Heller, 2021; Iozzelli, 2023; Stierl, 2018) while some have also started to take note of the spatial specificities of maritime territories (Mainwaring & DeBono, 2021; Noori, 2022; Pezzani & Heller, 2019). Indeed, geographers in particular have begun to conceptualize the latter in the context of different struggles, including maritime workers mobilisations (Featherstone, 2022; Griffin, 2015, 2022), anti-colonial mobilizations (Davies, 2013, 2019, 2020) and marine environmental movements (Drakopulos et al., 2022; Fish, 2022).

Drawing on and contributing to this emerging literature on sea-oriented acts of resistance, the aim of this article is to demonstrate why an ocean-focussed and extra-national agenda is both necessary and fruitful for social movement scholars. In what follows, I offer an initial framework for analysis by drawing out three sea-specific aspects that speak to *particular spatial qualities of ocean activism*, namely: (1) material specificity, (2) technological dependency and (2) extra-territoriality. As I will demonstrate for each of these sections, an oceanic turn in social movement scholarship can advance our understanding of transnational social movements in numerous ways, but particularly with regards to their spatial politics.

Understanding ocean-specific aspects of ocean activism

Material specificity

To begin with, acting outside national territory means to shift our view of transnational mobilizations from the issue of (local to global) *scale* to the *materiality* of the 'ground' on which movements act. Indeed, there is something specific about the materiality of the sea, which we need to understand to grasp sea-oriented phenomena like ocean activism. Across the recent ocean turn, scholars have employed various adjectives to signal the *turbulent* (Lehman et al., 2021) and 'messy materiality' of ocean space (Lehman, 2018, p. 58). Peters et al. argue that the ocean – like other spaces 'beyond *terra*', such as airspace or the underground – may be understood as '"ungrounded" spaces', that is 'spaces whose properties differ from that of solid land' and 'challenge territorial norms that have been developed with reference to an idealised world of solid, static land masses, controlled at surface level' (Peters et al., 2018, p. 3, original emphasis). Notable characteristics of these spaces include 'their indeterminacy, dynamism, and fluidity' (p. 3; Steinberg, 2013; Steinberg & Peters, 2015). Thus, while we must be careful not to romanticize or overstate the ocean's differences from the land, as scholars like Lehman et al. (2021) remind us, one question that is key to understanding the spatial politics of maritime movements is how the sea's specific material characteristics as a *fluid*, *turbulent* or *dynamic* environment come to *matter* for non-state actors seeking to act politically in ocean space.

Firstly, the sea's dynamic spatiality presents numerous challenges for ocean activists, such as through tidal movements, waves, currents or the movements of marine species. As Fish puts it with regards to the 'pan-directional manoeuvrability' of marine environmental actor Sea Shepherd's direct action vessels: 'The ocean endows these direct actions with fluid mobility and buoyancy, while also at times inhibiting the vigilante justice they were deployed to enforce' (Fish, 2022, p. 2). Fish illustrates ocean activists' struggle with the sea's materiality by pointing to the 'adverse weather conditions' and 'constraints imposed by elemental forces', which actors such as Sea Shepherd encounter in their sea-going maritime conservation work (p.4).

Similarly, the sea's *volumetric* and *vertical* properties shape 'new territories of control and conflict' (Steinberg & Peters, 2015, p. 252), raising both challenges and opportunities for ocean activists. Here, Steinberg and Peters contribute to wider discussions in geography (e.g. Hung & Lien, 2022), which highlight the need to understand territory not only as a flat surface but in its three-dimensionality. Drawing on respective discussions, Fish (2022) illustrates the importance of this conceptual move for better understanding sea-oriented resistance based on Sea Shepherd's 'elemental activism', which takes place in the air, *above* the sea (through drones), *on* the sea (on direct action vessels) and *in* the sea (where the species they seek to protect live). What Fish's account demonstrates, then, is the need to better understand 'the specific ways in which activism is mediated by the elements' (Fish, 2022, p. 2).

Moreover, ocean scholarship demonstrated why we need to understand the ocean as 'more-that-wet', not only through its 'transformation to other elements' (Peters & Steinberg, 2019, p. 2; see also Lehman et al., 2021). For Peters and Steinberg, this includes how the ocean extends *beyond* itself – towards and across the land, through ice, weather and smells – as well as how it travels *metaphorically* in our imagination, through literature, art and poetry. This, again, has several implications for sea-oriented acts of resistance. For instance, thinking about how the sea extends through the bodies and actions of those whose livelihoods depend on it points to the struggles of mariners and dockworkers whose resistance often takes place on the sea's edges, that is on shore and in ports (Featherstone, 2022; Griffin, 2022). Griffin (2022) thus suggests we understand maritime protest as spatially distributed, distinguishing between acts taking place *at sea, across the sea* and sea-oriented protests taking place *on land.*

As this section began to demonstrate, the ocean's fluid nature and material specificity raises not only practical challenges for sea-going activists, but also theoretical and conceptual challenges for social movement scholars. As, Steinberg and Peters remind us, Castells (1996) already employed notions of flow, dynamism and circulation in his theory of the networked society. Yet, they also criticize how flow referred, here, to an abstract concept rather than to the material environments crossed. A conceptual turn to how movements organize in ocean space thus reminds us that transnational mobilizations do not only grapple with scope and scale, but also with the *materiality* of the spaces in which they organize. In the case of ocean activism, this means attaining to the elemental qualities of the sea and how they influence activists' capacity to act on and beyond the sea's surface, including in the air, under water and on land.

Here, ocean scholarship intersects with wider geographical discussions of *verticality* (e.g. Steinberg & Peters, 2015) and *elemental geographies* (e.g. Engelmann & McCormack, 2021), from which social movement scholars can benefit, including for

conceptualizations of political acts in other extra-national terrains, such as the atmosphere or outer space. As Hughes (2020) argued, in times when geographic scholarship has reached a theoretical impasse of understanding resistance as being 'everywhere', attention to the specific materiality of transnational social movement action may offer a new route into how resistance may be conceptualized.

Technological dependency

As discussed at the beginning of this article, transnational mobilizations always rely, in one way or another, on media technologies (e.g. Castells, 2012; Flesher Fominaya, 2014). Ocean activism is no exception. Like other environmental movements, Sea Shepherd activists, for instance, think of 'media as a weapon' (Watson cited in Scarce, 2006, p. 104) when producing spectacular imagery of sea-oriented struggle. Moreover, like the networked politics of the alter-globalization movements (Juris, 2008) or the movements of the squares' use of social networks (Castells, 2012), maritime movements, too, use media for the purpose of organizing and connecting actors across geographies. For example, Noori (2022) has shown how mobile phones are essential in connecting land- and sea-based actors in the struggle against the EU's violent border regime in the Mediterranean. Yet, as this section will show: there is a crucial difference between land- and sea-oriented actors' relationship with media technologies: activism in extra-national terrain uniquely depends on the use of *sea-specific* technologies which, in turn, produce a particular kind of spatial politics.

As several scholars demonstrated, the sea is an environment which human bodies cannot *occupy* for longer periods of time without the aid of technological tools (whether this may be a surfboard, scuba equipment, the use of a vessel or remote sensing technology). The (high) seas in particular are 'decidedly hostile to permanent human habitation' (Steinberg, 1999, p. 367) and 'cannot be permanently occupied and settled as is the case on land' (Campling & Colás, 2021, p. 2). Drawing on her work with scuba divers, Straughan illustrates humans' dependency on technological support at sea by arguing that 'it was common for divers to adhere to the perception that we do not "belong" under the water', precisely because 'the body's presence in the aquatic world is facilitated through an assemblage of *technologies*' (Straughan, 2012, p. 21, emphasis added). Similarly, writing about physical oceanographers, whose work relies on ship-based or remote sensing technologies, Lehman concludes that 'it is virtually impossible to encounter the ocean without mediation, [...] humans must have relationships with machines to make sense of it' (Lehman, 2018, p. 74). Like divers and oceanographers, sea-oriented activists similarly depend on nautical and maritime technologies to act politically at sea, as the following examples of ships and maritime data technologies illustrate.

Despite ever progressing technological advancements, the ship remains 'an essential technology' (Fish, 2022, p. 2) of sea-oriented resistance. Historically, it is here where 'the very term "strike"' originates, namely 'from the collective decision of London seamen to strike the sails of their ships in 1768, halting the flow of commerce and the accumulation of capital' (Rediker, 1987, p. 205). Today, civil sea rescue in the Mediterranean, for example, largely depends on a 'civilian' or 'humanitarian fleet' (Stierl, 2018) of search and rescue vessels operated by different civil society actors. For Sea-Watch, the acquisition of a vessel – an old Dutch cutter which offered space

for eight crew members and, after severe adjustment, a few hundred passengers (p. 714) – stood at the beginning of their political action at sea (see also Noori, 2022, p. 1860). Similarly, Sea Shepherd commenced its direct actions with the purchase of a vessel, which 'began life in 1960 as a 779-ton, 206-foot-long deep-water trawler' and which activists subsequently turned into an anti-whaling vessel (Scarce, 2006, p. 98; see also Fish, 2022). In the case of Ships to Gaza, it was a fleet of eight vessels operated by different organizations from several countries that enabled the campaign's purpose to enact international solidarity (Kosmatopoulos, 2019, p. 740).

While much more can be said about the important role of ships, what is most interesting for my argument here is that ships produce a particular kind of spatial politics. On the one hand, there are the complex spatial politics *onboard* (Davies, 2013; Hechter et al., 2016; McDaniel, 2011), which generate a particular kind of sociality in which actors from different backgrounds can come together as a *motley crew* (Linebaugh & Rediker, 2013). On the other hand, the coming together of different campaign ships into a civic *fleet* (Kosmatopoulos, 2019, 2023; Stierl, 2018) creates a new spatial imagination of resistance that exceeds any decidedly nation-centred political logic.

Secondly, while ships remain a key technology, ocean activists also increasingly rely on digital technologies and *data activism* (Milan & van der Velden, 2016), specifically for land-based ocean-oriented action. One form of *maritime data activism* is the use of AIS data by civil sea rescue actors in the Mediterranean. AIS (Automatic Identification System) is a maritime technology, mandatory in commercial seafaring to avoid collisions, which makes vessel and journey data available globally through a combination of VHF radio, GPS and satellite technologies (Pezzani & Heller, 2019). Applied in migrant solidarity actions in the Mediterranean, AIS produces a particular spatiality within which respective actors struggle. On the one hand, navigational technologies like AIS may be understood as *planetary technologies* in that they have always *looked to the sky* to enable 'oceanic voyages on a global scale' (p. 887). On the other hand, AIS produces an 'uneven geography' (p. 888), both in terms of significantly varying satellite coverage as well as the highly unequal mobility regime in which AIS is entangled.

Another example that illustrates how maritime data technologies produce a complex spatial politics is a recent study of Global Fishing Watch's use of algorithms and vessel location data in the struggle against overfishing (Drakopulos et al., 2022). Here, data technologies are employed by non-state actors to tackle the lack of enforcement of marine environmental standards. Yet, Drakopulos et al. reveal a crucial limitation of this approach: in mapping vessels engaged in illicit fishing activity by flag state rather than by the actors who financially benefit from this activity, 'the incentives, firms and practices that drive overfishing [remain] invisible' (Drakopulos et al., 2022, p. 11). In other words, the transnational ambitions of ocean activism collide, here, with the nation-based order of political organization.

Indeed, it is important to stress that nation-states limit sea-oriented acts of resistance not only conceptually, but also legally, as in the case of European nation-states criminalizing solidarity with maritime migrants, or physically, through the interception and detention of vessels, as in the case of the Gaza Freedom Flotilla (Kosmatopoulos, 2023). As Kosmatopoulos demonstrates, nation-state power is both resisted and perpetuated at sea.

What the examples cited in this section illustrate, then, is that the use of data-driven technologies in ocean activism does not *automatically* lead to a spatial imagination that transcends nation-state boundaries. After all, a ship, too, is as a piece of floating national territory in that it is bound by national legislation via its respective flag state. Nevertheless, a closer consideration of ocean activists' use of technologies, such as ships or AIS, fruitfully complicates our understanding of transnational social movements' spatial and data politics, in that it calls on social movement scholars to pay closer attention to *what kind of spatial imagination and possibilities* specific technologies (re-) produce. At best, a respective consideration may point to new forms of spatial organization emerging in extra-national terrain, such as the idea of a *civil fleet* (Stierl, 2018).

Extra-territoriality

In this final section, I turn to the specific challenges and opportunities arising due to the sea's cultural and legal construction as a space *outside* or *on the edges of* the nation-state. Indeed, there is a 'fundamental idealised divide between land (which can be transformed into territory) and water (which cannot)' which 'underpins the modern system of territorial state sovereignty' (Steinberg & Peters, 2015, p. 260). As Steinberg demonstrates, between 1500 and 1800, 'the concept of boundable space (territory) was becoming essential for political organization' (Steinberg, 2009, p. 468). While terrestrial space became the foundational container of politics, Steinberg shows how the planetary ocean simultaneously became important as the modern nation-state's *constitutive outside*. In other words, in the normative worldview of modern societies, ocean space is defined by its *extra-territorial* quality, that is as a space rendered as lying 'beyond territorial control' (p. 467) and thus 'society's geographic limits' (p. 470). Today, the sea is governed by a complex legal framework, which distinguishes between the high seas, which lie beyond national jurisdiction, and territorial waters or exclusive economic zones, to which bordering nations have specific access rights. As Arella summarizes: 'As one moves further and further away from the shoreline, the sovereignty of the state decreases' (Arella, 2017, p. 5).

The ocean's legal and social construction (Steinberg, 2001) as extra-territorial impacts on sea-oriented acts of resistance in numerous ways. For instance, in the case of civil sea rescue in the Mediterranean, civil society jumps into action precisely because of a 'maritime void' left by states (Stierl, 2016, p. 561), who do not live up to their obligation to rescue people in distress at sea despite designated Search and Rescue zones. Mainwaring and DeBono explain this void as created by the Mediterranean being simultaneously understood as 'our sea' (*mare nostrum)* and 'nobody's sea' (*mare nullius*), a conceptual ambiguity exploited by European nation-states to erase both their colonial histories and present responsibilities (Mainwaring & DeBono, 2021, p. 1034).

At the same time, the sea's legal construction as international territory enables transgressive action. As Arella (2017) demonstrates, the group Women on Waves exploits the sea's particular legalities by deliberately flying their vessel under a Dutch flag to enact their mission of empowering women to exercise their right to bodily autonomy. Complying with Dutch law, they use the vessel to perform 'on-ship abortions [. . .] outside the territorial waters' of states where abortion rights are restricted (p. 22).

Here, the fluid legality of the sea holds transgressive potential that may enable different ways of acting *outside* the borders of nation-states.

Shifting our view to the extra-territorial space of the ocean also makes visible political actors who emerge over a shared maritime, rather than national history. As Swan (2022) illustrates in his account of the Black Pacific, turning to the sea can give way to better understanding movements that have, thus far, received insufficient scholarly attention, such as the Black internationalism that has traversed the oceans in the latter half of the twentieth century. Similarly, the work of the Black Mediterranean Collective (2021) shows the Mediterranean Sea as a site of deeply racist and violent colonial history, thereby both highlighting the agency of actors like migrants, refugees and enslaved people and offering alternative ways of understanding how the ocean has functioned as a space of transnational mobilization (McDaniel, 2011) that gives way to different kinds of *internationalism from below* (Featherstone, 2022).

While sea-oriented resistance opens up paths to alternative political imaginations *outside of* nation-centred narrations, it is crucial to highlight that maritime politics are *not detached from* but remain entangled with land-based developments. Besides the aforementioned nation-state-imposed limitations, ocean activism can also benefit from connections made with land-based actors. This is the case, for instance, in the Ships to Gaza campaign, during which ship-based activists formed close alliances not only with shipyard and maritime workers but also got involved with the movements of the squares, which were active in Greece around the same time (Kosmatopoulos, 2023). As Kosmatopoulos argues, conceptual attention to the relations between land- and sea-based struggles raises questions about how struggles are framed, such as in the 'contrasting spatial logics' (p. 10) of the *ship* (operating in *fluid* terrain) and the *square* (which is to be *occupied*).

On the other hand, while sea-oriented acts of resistance may help challenge national hegemony, they may still include the nation-state in different ways. Griffin (2015) shows how racialized tensions in local workers' disputes in Glasgow's Red Clydeside were at odds with the progressive internationalism of simultaneous sailor mobilizations. Another example is the shifting and complex relationship between states and civil sea rescue actors in the Mediterranean Sea. As Heller points out, the first Mediterranean rescue NGOs were initially acting 'very much in *support* of state activities', although many later became more oppositional in the context of the criminalization of solidarity (Heller, 2021, p. 20, original emphasis). A third example is the case of the maritime anticolonial nationalism of the Swadeshi Steamship Navigation Company (Davies, 2020). As Davies reminds us, the company was founded in order 'to create an "indigenous" shipping company' in the context of British rule and thus to 'disrupt the British monopoly on shipping lines' connecting the ports of Tuticorin and Colombo (p. 77). The company's agenda was in line with swadeshi activism, which operated on the belief that 'the development of a national economy would encourage a period of national "self-renewal"' and make up a crucial part of Indian independence (p. 73).

What is particularly relevant about this latter case for my own argument is that what Davies' calls *maritime anti-colonialisms* (p. 83) is not merely an extension of anti-colonial nationalism into maritime terrain. Davies shows this by pointing to swadeshi activists' *archipelagic* (p. 84) ways of organising, which connected both 'landed', local spaces across different regional identities, as well as actions and protests in port cities like Tuticorin

and the ambitions of the SSNC. For Davies, 'more than simply saying anticolonial activity happened on ships', the reason why the maritime dimension of anti-colonialism needs to be taken seriously derives from the observation 'that political formations and activities in maritime spaces were distinct and productive of a different set of political relations' (Davies, 2020, p. 85).

It is precisely in this potential to widen our understanding of the spatial politics of transnational social movements that a conceptual turn to the ocean becomes particularly potent. As Hughes (2020) diagnosed, one impasse that geographic understandings of resistance reached in recent years is that scholars struggle to recognize resistance beyond predefined *forms*. Building on Hughes' observation, we may argue that one conceptual limitation of how transnational resistance is understood, is that it has primarily been conceptualized with reference to how it relates to the predominant *nation-state form* of political organising (*below* or *beyond*). Due to its specific spatial position, operating *outside* or on the *edges* of nation-states, ocean activism challenges the predefined national container of politics. Thus, 'less "terra-centric"' (Davies, 2019, p. 2) views enable a 'disruption of certainty' which is necessary to 'open up glimpses of alternative political futures' (Hughes, 2020, p. 1154).

Conclusions

The aim of this article was to begin to address a crucial gap in social movement scholarship, namely its terrestrial bias, by offering a conceptualization of ocean activism. As I have shown throughout this conceptualization, scholarly attention to ocean-oriented acts of resistance opens up new paths to understanding transnational mobilizations in particular. In sum, what, then, is it that the extra-national perspective of the sea brings into view for social movement scholars?

Firstly, what I have shown throughout the article is that sea-oriented acts of resistance are never disconnected from the land but remain entangled with land-based politics in numerous ways. This may be in terms land- and ocean-based movements working *together*, as in the case of the maritime anti-colonialisms described by Davies (2020) and Kosmatopoulos (2023), or, indeed, competing with one another, as in the case of Glasgow's Red Clydeside (Griffin, 2015). At the same time, ocean activists are entangled in a complex relationship with land-based and nation-centred forms of governance – at times able to circumvent national restrictions at sea, as in the case of Women against Waves (Arella, 2017), while hindered, at other times, by the land-based, national order, as in the case of Global Fishing Watch's dependency on limiting vessel data (Drakopulos et al., 2022).

At the same time, what this article has demonstrated is that there are sea-specific aspects to ocean-oriented acts of resistance – enacted both at sea and on land – that deserve our conceptual attention. In this article, I have suggested that we may understand ocean activism along three defining characteristics, namely its (1) material specificity, (2) technological dependency and (3) extra-territoriality. More than providing an initial framework of how ocean activism may be theorized, this discussion aimed to demonstrate that addressing social movement scholarship's terrestrial bias broadens both our

empirical and theoretical horizons and opens up avenues for further scholarly enquiry into ocean activism as well as resistance in other extra-national terrains.

Empirically, a turn to the sea firstly allows us to correct land-biased understandings of social movements that scholars have been writing about for some time. This includes the maritime dimension of global justice movements (Armstrong, 2022; Federici, 2014) and the movements of the squares (Kosmatopoulos, 2023), which scholars have, thus far, largely ignored, as well as the maritime dimension of anti-colonial activism (Davies, 2020; Kosmatopoulos, 2023; Swan, 2022). One possible strand of future research on ocean activism may thus explore how the often-overlooked *maritime* expressions of known movements, including in feminist, environmental, climate and workers struggles, alter our understandings of respective mobilizations.

Theoretically, social movement scholars' turn to the ocean invites us to expand our theoretical repertoire. In this article, I focussed specifically on how our understanding of the spatial politics of transnational social movements alters when shifting our view from how mobilizations operate not only *below* and *across* but also *outside* or *on the edges* of nation-state territory. Here, a turn to the sea invites new discourses and concepts into social movement studies. Concepts like verticality or materiality do not only help to better understand ocean activism but point to broader questions around what it means for movements to organize in and around different elements, from water (see also Matthews, 2023), vapour and ice to air (Engelmann & McCormack, 2021) to other extra-national geographies, from the depths of the earth to outer space.

Finally, I demonstrated that the ocean lends itself as a fruitful terrain from which to revisit established concepts in social movement scholarship. This includes not only our understanding of movements' spatial politics but also concepts like collective identity or data activism. As my discussion of ships and AIS technologies demonstrated, a turn to the sea holds the potential to raise novel questions and produce new concepts, metaphors and units like those of the *civil fleet* (Stierl, 2018) or *archipelagic anti-colonialism* (Davies, 2020). Ultimately, then, what a turn to the sea adds to existing social movement scholarship is to challenge the often terra-centric foundations of our theoretical vocabulary and invite such further explorations of mobilizations in both national *and* extra-national terrain.

Disclosure statement

No potential conflict of interest was reported by the author.

Funding

This work was supported by the University of St Gallen's International Postdoctoral Fellowship under Grant 1031585.

Notes on contributor

Antje Scharenberg is a social movement scholar whose research focusses on transnational activism. In her current position as International Postdoctoral Fellow at the University of St Gallen, Antje investigates ocean activism and what it means to act politically at sea, with a particular focus on civil sea rescue in the Mediterranean and marine environmental activism the European Atlantic. In previous projects, Antje studied civil society resistance against algorithmic decision making and alter-European activist networks in times of Brexit.

ORCID

Antje Scharenberg http://orcid.org/0000-0002-2349-4838

References

Arella, A. (2017). *Murky waters – evaluating the role of campaign ships on the high seas* (Working Paper Volume 5 No 7). McGill Centre for Human Rights and Legal Pluralism. https://www.mcgill.ca/humanrights/files/humanrights/ihri_wps_v5_n07_arella.pdf

Armstrong, C. (2022). *A blue new deal: Why we need a new politics for the ocean*. Yale University Press.

Armstrong, C., & Scharenberg, A. (2023). Ocean justice: Rethinking global justice from the sea. *Soundings*, *83*(83), 8–20. https://doi.org/10.3898/SOUN.83.01.2023

The Black Mediterranean Collective (Ed.). (2021). *The Black Mediterranean: Bodies, borders and citizenship*. Palgrave Macmillan.

Brown, M., & Peters, K. (2019). *Living with the sea: Knowledge, awareness and action*. Routledge.

Campling, L., & Colás, A. (2021). *Capitalism and the sea: The maritime factor in the making of the Modern World*. Verso.

Castells, M. (1996). *The rise of the network society*. Blackwell Publishers.

Castells, M. (2012). *Networks of outrage and hope: Social movements in the internet age*. Polity Press.

Colás, A. (2022). International relations' sea sickness: A materialist diagnosis. In B. de Carvalho & H. Leira, (Eds). *The sea and International Relations* (pp. 26–49). Manchester University Press.

Davies, A. (2013). Identity and the assemblages of protest: The spatial politics of the Royal Indian Navy mutiny, 1946. *Geoforum; Journal of Physical, Human, and Regional Geosciences*, *48*, 24–32. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.geoforum.2013.03.013

Davies, A. (2019). Transnational connections and anti-colonial radicalism in the Royal Indian Navy mutiny, 1946. *Global Networks*, *19*(4), 521–538. https://doi.org/10.1111/glob.12256

Davies, A. (2020). *Geographies of anticolonialism: Political networks across and beyond South India, c. 1900-1930*. Wiley.

della Porta, D., & Caiani, M. (2009). *Social movements and europeanization*. Oxford University Press.

della Porta, D., & Diani, M. (2006). *Social movements: An introduction* (2nd ed). Blackwell Publishing.

della Porta, D., & Steinhilper, E. (2022). *Contentious migrant solidarity: Shrinking spaces and civil society contestation*. Routledge.

della Porta, D., & Tarrow, S. G. (Eds.). (2005). *Transnational protest and global activism*. Rowman & Littlefield.

Drakopulos, L., Silver, J. J., Nost, E., Gray, N., & Hawkins, R. (2022). Making global oceans governance In/visible with smart earth: The case of Global Fishing Watch. *Environment and Planning E: Nature and Space*, *6*(2), 1098–1113. Advance online publication. https://doi.org/10.1177/25148486221111786.

Engelmann, S., & McCormack, D. (2021). Elemental worlds: Specificities, exposures, alchemies. *Progress in Human Geography*, *45*(6), 1419–1439. https://doi.org/10.1177/0309132520987301

Featherstone, D. (2022). Solidarities: Ocean spaces and internationalism from below. In K. Peters, J. Anderson, A. Davies, & P. Steinberg, Eds. *The Routledge Handbook of Ocean space* (pp. 236–246). Routledge.

Federici, S. (2014). Translator's preface. In M. D. C. In & M. Chilese (Eds.). *Our mother ocean: Enclosure, commons, and the global fishermen's movement* (pp. 11–16). Common Notions.

Fish, A. (2022). Blue governmentality: Elemental activism with conservation technologies on plundered seas. *Political Geography 93*, 102528. Advance online publication. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.polgeo.2021.102528.

Flesher Fominaya, C. (2014). *Social movements and globalization: How protests, occupations and uprisings are changing the world*. Palgrave Macmillan.

Flesher Fominaya, C., & Cox, L. (Eds.). (2013). *Understanding European movements: New social movements, global justice struggles, anti-austerity protest*. Routledge.

Griffin, P. (2015). Labour struggles and the formation of demands: The spatial politics of Red Clydeside. *Geoforum; Journal of Physical, Human, and Regional Geosciences*, *62*, 121–130. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.geoforum.2015.04.009

Griffin, P. (2022). Protest: Contested hierarchies and grievances at sea. In K. Peters, J. Anderson, A. Davies, & P. Steinberg, (Eds). *The Routledge Handbook of Ocean Space* (pp. 223–235). Routledge.

Hechter, M., Pfaff, S., & Underwood, P. (2016). Grievances and the Genesis of Rebellion: Mutiny in the Royal Navy, 1740 to 1820. *American Sociological Review*, *81*(1), 165–189. https://doi.org/10.1177/0003122415618991

Heller, C. (2021). (Un)contentious solidarity at sea. In D. D. Porta & E.Steinhilper, Eds. *Contentious migrant solidarity* (pp. 19–43). Routledge. https://doi.org/10.4324/9781003083429-2

Hughes, S. M. (2020). On resistance in human geography. *Progress in Human Geography*, *44*(6), 1141–1160. https://doi.org/10.1177/0309132519879490

Hung, P.-Y., & Lien, Y.-H. (2022). Maritime borders: A reconsideration of state power and territorialities over the ocean. *Progress in Human Geography*, *46*(3), 870–889. Advance online publication. https://doi.org/10.1177/03091325221074698

Iozzelli, J. (2023). Life on board ship and cultural intimacy. Notes from the Central Mediterranean. *Archivio antropologico mediterraneo*, *25*(1). https://doi.org/10.4000/aam.6955

Juris, J. S. (2008). *Networking futures: The movements against corporate globalization*. Duke University Press.

Kosmatopoulos, N. (2019). On the shores of politics: Sea, solidarity and the ships to Gaza. *Environment and Planning D: Society and Space*, *37*(4), 740–757. https://doi.org/10.1177/0263775818823750

Kosmatopoulos, N. (2023). A People's sea: Palestine and popular thalassopolitics in the Mediterranean sea. *Millennium: Journal of International Studies*, *51*(3), 739–757. Advance online publication. https://doi.org/10.1177/03058298231175523

Lang, S. (2012). *NGOs, civil society, and the public sphere*. Cambridge University Press.

Lehman, J. (2018). From ships to robots: The social relations of sensing the world ocean. *Social Studies of Science*, *48*(1), 57–79. https://doi.org/10.1177/0306312717743579

Lehman, J., Steinberg, P., & Johnson, E. (2021). Turbulent waters in three parts. *Theory & Event*, *24*(1), 192–219. https://doi.org/10.1353/tae.2021.0007

Linebaugh, P., & Rediker, M. (2013). *The many-headed hydra: sailors, slaves, commoners, and the hidden history of the revolutionary Atlantic* (Second edition). Beacon Press.

Mainwaring, Ċ., & DeBono, D. (2021). Criminalizing solidarity: Search and rescue in a neo-colonial sea. *Environment and Planning C: Politics and Space*, *39*(5), 1030–1048. https://doi.org/10.1177/2399654420979314

Matthews, J. (2023). Waves, floods, currents: The politics and poetics of water in social movement analysis. *Antipode*, *55* (6), 1822–1840. https://doi.org/10.1111/anti.12946

McDaniel, W. C. (2011). Saltwater anti-slavery: American abolitionists on the Atlantic Ocean in the age of steam. *Atlantic Studies*, *8*(2), 141–163. https://doi.org/10.1080/14788810.2011.562349

McFarlane, C. (2009). Translocal assemblages: Space, power and social movements. *Geoforum; Journal of Physical, Human, and Regional Geosciences*, *40*(4), 561–567. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.geoforum.2009.05.003

Milan, S., & van der Velden, L. (2016). The alternative epistemologies of data activism. *Digital Culture & Society*, *2*(2), 57–74. https://doi.org/10.14361/dcs-2016-0205

Noori, S. (2022). Navigating the Aegean Sea: Smartphones, transnational activism and viapolitical in(ter)ventions in contested maritime borderzones. *Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies*, *48*(8), 1856–1872. https://doi.org/10.1080/1369183X.2020.1796265

Peters, K., & Steinberg, P. (2019). The ocean in excess: Towards a more-than-wet ontology. *Dialogues in Human Geography*, *9*(3), 293–307. https://doi.org/10.1177/2043820619872886

Peters, K., Steinberg, P., & Stratford, E. (Eds.). (2018). *Territory beyond terra*. Rowman & Littlefield.

Pezzani, L., & Heller, C. (2019). AIS politics: The contested use of vessel tracking at the EU's maritime frontier. *Science, Technology, & Human Values*, *44*(5), 881–899. https://doi.org/10.1177/0162243919852672

Rediker, M. (1987). *Between the Devil and the Deep Blue Sea: merchant seamen, pirates, and the anglo-american maritime world, 1700-1750*. Cambridge University Press.

Routledge, P. (2003). Convergence space: Process geographies of grassroots globalization networks. *Transactions of the Institute of British Geographers*, *28*(3), 333–349. https://doi.org/10.1111/1475-5661.00096

Scarce, R. (2006). *Eco-warriors: Understanding the radical environmental movement*. Left Coast Press.

Scharenberg, A. (2021a). Alter- not pro-european: The question of europe in transnational Activist networks. In P. Blokker (Ed.), *Imagining Europe* (pp. 59–88). Springer International Publishing. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-81369-7_3

Scharenberg, A. (2021b). *Transeuropa: Agency beyond borders in alter-european activist networks* [PhD thesis]. Goldsmiths, University of London.

Scharenberg, A. (2022). Sea changes: How ocean activism reshapes the way we see borders, sovereignty and power. *The Sociological Review Magazine*. https://doi.org/10.51428/tsr.dhlo7063

Squire, R. (2021). *Undersea geopolitics: Sealab, science, and the cold war*. Rowman & Littlefield.

Steinberg, P. (1999). Navigating to multiple horizons: Toward a geography of ocean-space. *The Professional Geographer*, *51*(3), 366–375. https://doi.org/10.1111/0033-0124.00172

Steinberg, P. (2001). *The social construction of the ocean*. Cambridge University Press.

Steinberg, P. (2009). Sovereignty, territory, and the mapping of mobility: A view from the outside. *Annals of the Association of American Geographers*, *99*(3), 467–495. https://doi.org/10.1080/00045600902931702

Steinberg, P. (2013). Of other seas: Metaphors and materialities in maritime regions. *Atlantic Studies*, *10*(2), 156–169. https://doi.org/10.1080/14788810.2013.785192

Steinberg, P., & Peters, K. (2015). Wet ontologies, fluid spaces: Giving depth to volume through oceanic thinking. *Environment and Planning D: Society and Space*, *33*(2), 247–264. https://doi.org/10.1068/d14148p

Stierl, M. (2016). A sea of struggle – Activist border interventions in the Mediterranean sea. *Citizenship Studies*, *20*(5), 561–578. https://doi.org/10.1080/13621025.2016.1182683

Stierl, M. (2018). A fleet of Mediterranean border humanitarians. *Antipode*, *50*(3), 704–724. https://doi.org/10.1111/anti.12320

Straughan, E. R. (2012). Touched by water: The body in scuba diving. *Emotion, Space and Society*, *5*(1), 19–26. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.emospa.2010.10.003

Swan, Q. (2022). *Pasifika Black: Oceania, anti-colonialism, and the African world*. New York University Press.